level ground close to the village, instead of where the defensive canal would have protected them much more. There they laid down carelessly, without scouts or any rearward troops.

The morning had just begun when Qaṃbar-‘alī Beg’s shouts echoed hard. He was shouting, ‘Up with you! The enemy is here!’

Babur’s fear and judgement from last evening had proven to be true.

He asked the men to take positions as soon as possible. Unlike his habit of lying down to think even in times of emergencies, Babur was up in his tunic instantly. He put on the sword and quiver and mounted on the horse briskly. The standard-bearer could not adjust the standards in this time of rush. He just mounted with it in his hand. Babur had around fifteen men with him when he started riding towards the enemy. After riding like an arrow, Babur came across enemies’ scouts, numbering around ten. Going briskly as they could, enemies showered arrows on Babur as he overtook them. Babur overmastered his foremost men and hurried them off. Babur along with his men followed them at great speed and came up with his centre where Sulṭān Aḥmad Taṃbal stood firm. He was accompanied by around 100 men. He stood in front of his array like a gatekeeper, strong and brave. He yelled, ‘Strike, strike!’

But something unusual happened. Most of his men were sidling. They appeared to be in a state of fix, questioning themselves, ‘Shall we run away? Shall we not?’

Of the fifteen accompanying Babur, only three were left namely, Nāṣir Dost, Mīrzā Qulī Kūkūldāsh and Khudāī-bīrdī Turkmān Karīm-dād.

Babur shot off an arrow on his thumb, aimed at Taṃbal’s helm. Doing so, when Babur put his hand into his quiver, there came out a new *gosha-gīr*[2] that was given to him by his younger Khān dada. Babur felt that it indeed would have been annoying to throw it away, however, the situation required him to shoot a couple of arrows. Then once again, he placed an arrow on the string and went forward, while his three men held back the stand. Taṃbal moved forward as well. The high road lay between both. Babur from his side and he from his climbed upon the high road finally facing each other. His right hand was towards Babur and vice versa. Except for the mail of his horse, he was fully accoutred. On the other hand, Babur was completely unprotected, devoid of any armour.